

Does the multipathogen monograph cite the right papers? what should it cite?

The monograph **partly cites** the right papers, but it is **missing key empirical anchors** and should cite them.

The attached multipathogen monograph makes several claims that are well aligned with the literature, especially on VSP thresholding, cruise-ship norovirus epidemiology, and Diamond Princess as a respiratory calibration frame, but it currently includes **no external bibliography** despite relying on those ideas (Kirkup, 2026). The attached cost-effectiveness CTB report already contains many of the core references the monograph should inherit for norovirus prevalence, shedding, VSP outbreak epidemiology, cruise-specific risk factors, immunity, and genotype emergence (Kirkup, 2026).

Core Judgment

The monograph is **directionally right** on three central claims: cruise ships are useful confined-environment outbreak models, VSP observations are post-response rather than no-response data, and norovirus and respiratory pathogens behave differently under onboard detection and response (Kirkup, 2026). Those claims should be tied to external empirical and modeling papers rather than left supported only by internal CTB outputs (Kirkup, 2026; Srinivasan et al., 2024; Srinivasan et al., 2026).

The strongest missing citation for the **3% VSP trigger** is the AGID shipboard ABM paper, which explicitly implements VSP when infected persons reach 3% of the ship population (Srinivasan et al., 2026; Srinivasan et al., 2024). The strongest missing citation for the claim that observed cruise outbreak attack rates cluster near the **5–7% range** is the VSP surveillance literature and cruise meta-analysis, which report a median passenger attack rate of 5.6% in calibration data and a weighted passenger attack rate of 7% across published outbreaks (Kirkup, 2026; Mouchtouri et al., 2024).

What to Cite

Monograph claim	Best papers to cite	Why
VSP outbreak threshold compresses observed attack rates	AGID 2026; Jenkins et al. 2021	Explicit 3% VSP trigger and reportable-outbreak framing (Srinivasan et al., 2026; Kirkup, 2026)
Cruise norovirus outbreaks are usually around 5–7% passenger AR	Jenkins et al. 2021; Mouchtouri et al. 2024	Median 5.6% and weighted 7% passenger AR (Kirkup, 2026; Mouchtouri et al., 2024)
Cabin/travel-group spread is a major route	Mouchtouri et al. 2024; Pluciński et al. 2020	Ill cabin mate OR 38.7; cabinmate SARS-CoV-2 risk 63–81% (Mouchtouri et al., 2024; Pluciński et al., 2020)
Multiple transmission routes and environmental persistence matter	Cramer et al. 2004	Multiple modes, persistence across cruises, environmental contamination (Cramer et al., 2004)

Monograph claim	Best papers to cite	Why
Diamond Princess is a respiratory calibration anchor	Yamagishi et al. 2020; Pluciński et al. 2020	Large shipboard SARS-CoV-2 outbreak with strong attack-rate and cabin data (Yamagishi et al., 2020; Pluciński et al., 2020)
Norovirus transmission is heterogeneous; parameter choice needs caution	Gaythorpe et al. 2017; Steele et al. 2020; Vesga et al. 2025	Wide R0 variation, median R0 2.75, genotype-specific dynamics, GII.4 R0 about 4.8 (Gaythorpe et al., 2017; Steele et al., 2020; Vesga et al., 2025)

FIGURE 1 Key literature the monograph should cite by claim

Gaps

The monograph should cite more than norovirus-only papers because it makes **multi-pathogen** claims about respiratory, environmental, and high-consequence pathogens (Kirkup, 2026). For respiratory calibration, Diamond Princess and the broader cruise COVID review are the right anchors; the review also shows that Diamond Princess, Grand Princess, and Greg Mortimer are the few ships with thorough epidemiologic descriptions, which is an important caveat on generalizability (Willebrand et al., 2022).

The weakest-supported part is the hantavirus extension. The attached monograph invokes MV Hondius as motivation, and the attached CTB report cites the 2026 Hondius paper; that paper is the right empirical citation, while the 2026 hantavirus cruise modeling preprint is at best contextual, not a primary validation source (Kirkup, 2026; Cui, 2026).

Bottom Line

Yes, the multipathogen monograph is **using the right literature themes**, but it should explicitly cite the empirical VSP, cruise norovirus, Diamond Princess, and norovirus transmission papers that already match its core claims. The most important additions are Jenkins 2021, Mouchtouri 2024, Cramer 2004, Yamagishi 2020, Pluciński 2020, Gaythorpe 2017, Steele 2020, Vesga 2025, and AGID 2026 (Kirkup, 2026; Yamagishi et al., 2020; Pluciński et al., 2020; Gaythorpe et al., 2017; Steele et al., 2020; Vesga et al., 2025; Srinivasan et al., 2026).

These search results were found and analyzed using Consensus, an AI-powered search engine for research. Try it at <https://consensus.app>. © 2026 Consensus NLP, Inc. Personal, non-commercial use only; redistribution requires copyright holders' consent.

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